

Yinan Wu

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Profile

A PhD student in Computer Science specializing in **Software Engineering** and **Human-Computer Interaction**. Experienced in user study design, usability evaluation, and mixed-methods analysis. Skilled at bridging empirical research with practical design to enhance usability, developer experience, and productivity. Passionate about advancing user experience through human-centered, data-driven methodology.

Education

PhD in Computer Science <i>North Carolina State University</i>	Aug 2024 – Present <i>Raleigh, USA</i>
MSc in Computer Science (Distinction) <i>University of Birmingham</i>	Sep 2022 – Dec 2023 <i>Birmingham, UK</i>
BEng in Materials Chemistry (Minor in English) <i>University of Science and Technology Beijing</i>	Aug 2015 – Jul 2019 <i>Beijing, China</i>

Publications

How Do Developers Interact with AI? An Exploratory Study on Modeling Developer Programming Behavior Yinan Wu , Ze Shi Li, Kathryn Thomasset Stolee, Bowen Xu Research Track International Conference on the Foundations of Software Engineering (FSE) 2026	Apr 2026
Hidden Licensing Risks in the LLMware Ecosystem <i>Bo Wang, Yueyang Chen, Jieke Shi, Minghui Li, Yunbo Lyu, Yinan Wu, Youfang Lin, Zhou Yang</i> Research Track International Symposium on Software Testing and Analysis (ISSTA) 2026	Apr 2026
Test Code Review in the Era of GitHub Actions: A Replication Study <i>Hui Sun, Yinan Wu, Wesley K.G. Assunção, Kathryn Thomasset Stolee</i> Under submission to Empirical Software Engineering (EMSE)	Mar 2026
Fast Code, Heavy Heart: Emotional Responses in AI-Assisted Programming Yinan Wu , Ze Shi Li, Kathryn Thomasset Stolee, Bowen Xu Poster Symposium on Visual Languages and Human-Centric Computing (VL/HCC) 2025	Aug 2025
Learning from the Best: What Makes a Hugging Face Model Popular? Yinan Wu , Zhou Yang, Bowen Xu, Bo Wang, Bach Le, David Lo Registered Reports International Conference on Software Maintenance and Evolution (ICSME) 2025	Jul 2025

Experience

Research Assistant (Summer) <i>Supervisor: Dr. Dominik Wermke, Department of Computer Science, NC State</i>	May 2026 – Aug 2026 <i>Raleigh, USA</i>
Research Assistant <i>Supervisor: Dr. Bowen Xu, Department of Computer Science, NC State</i>	Aug 2024 – Aug 2025 <i>Raleigh, USA</i>
Research Engineer <i>Supervisor: Dr. David Lo, School of Computing and Information Systems, SMU</i>	Jan 2024 – Aug 2024 <i>Singapore</i>

Teaching

Teaching Assistant

Computer Security, NC State

Jan 2026 – Apr 2026

Raleigh, USA

Teaching Assistant

CSC 554 Human-Computer Interaction (HCI), NC State

Aug 2025 – Dec 2025

Raleigh, USA

Skills

- **User Research:** Surveys, Interviews, Usability Testing, Think-Aloud Protocol, A/B Testing
- **Qualitative Analysis:** Collaborative Coding, Thematic Analysis, Grounded Theory
- **Quantitative Analysis:** Statistical Analysis, Mixed-methods, Visualization (Matplotlib, Seaborn)
- **Programming for Research:** Python, Java, JavaScript

Awards

Travel Grant Recipient

International Conference on Software Engineering (ICSE) 2025 Student Travel Grant

2025

References

Dr. Bowen Xu, *Assistant Professor, North Carolina State University*

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Dr. Kathryn Thomasset Stolee, *Associate Professor, North Carolina State University*

ktstolee@ncsu.edu

Dr. Dominik Wermke, *Assistant Professor, North Carolina State University*

dwormke@ncsu.edu

Dr. Ze Shi Li, *Assistant Professor, University of Oklahoma*

zeshili@ou.edu